

Moonveil

Version 1.1

foodpuzz & lunarsignals

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What You Need

- 2–6 players
- A ton of six-sided dice (d6s)
- Pencil, paper, and character sheets

Who is this for?

Something about the core design.

- Inspired by
 - OSR
 - MtG
 - Dungeon Meshi
- Combat Focused
- Pocket Push Rolls

Create Your Seeker

You are a Seeker exploring the Moonveil looking for fallen Pieces of the Moon.

Level, Abilities, and Hit Points

Start at **Level 1**.

Begin with two 2's and two 1's to assign to their four **Ability Points** in Strength, Dexterity, Insight, and Willpower.

You may choose where to place them yourself, or roll 1d6 and use the distribution from the table below:

d6	Strength	Dexterity	Insight	Willpower
1	2	2	1	1
2	2	1	2	1
3	2	1	1	2
4	1	2	2	1
5	1	2	1	2
6	1	1	2	2

Hit Points: Your distance from Death. Roll a single d6, add (3 x Strength).

Pocket: Your luck and momentum. Roll d6 and keep that die to track it.

Evade: Any attack roll equal to or under your Evade is a Miss. Start at 5.

Limit: Any attack roll equal to or over your Limit is a Critical Hit. Start at 10.

Hit Track: Shows the attack tiers against you. Draw a vertical line just right of your Evade and another just left of your Limit.

Defense: Add Evade and Pocket. Defense can never reach your Limit—if the total would meet or pass it, lower it to one less than your Limit. Place your Pocket die on your Hit Track at your Defense.

Finally fill in your **Name** and **Portrait**.

Equipment, Magic, and a Gift

Start with d6 **Coin** and 3 **Dungeon Gear**. Then choose or roll d66 twice for starting gifts.

d6	d6	Equipment and Magic
1-2	1	Sword. Hits do minimum 3 damage
	2	Spear. On a Strong Hit +2 damage
	3	Hammer. On a Critical Hit +d6*
	4	Bow. Ranged 2. Accurate
	5	Whip. On any hit target rolls Pocket Down
	6	A Bomb! 6d6 area damage
3-4	1-2	Helmet. Limit +1
	3-4	Shield. If Pocket is Odd then Evade +1
	5	Leather Armor. Damage Reduction -1, breaks on a Critical Hit
	6	Cloak. Can roll Pocket on Move, breaks on a Critical Hit
5	1-2	Air Pressure , Heavylite , and Moonsmell DC8 Spells
	3-4	Egress and Invisibility DC9 Spells
	5	Magic Orb DC10 Spell
	6	Sleepsand DC12 Spell
6	1-3	Healing Circle DC10 Miracle
	4-6	Dawn Arm DC11 Miracle

Roll d66 for a small, **Extra** Gift to take with you.

d6	d6	
1-3	1	A letter from a loved one...
	2	A bloody bag full of coins...
	3	A soapstone lion...
	4	A mysterious map...
	5	A rusted key...
	6	A package that makes ticking sounds...
4-6	1	A broken sword...
	2	A diary that writes itself...
	3	A key carved from a bone...
	4	A small hand mirror...
	5	A loaded pair of dice...
	6	A vial of blood...

Rolling and the Pocket Push

The core resolution is a controlled 2d6 roll, **The Pocket Push**. Your **Pocket** lets you swap luck between rolls, and your **Ability Points** can be spent to press harder when the dice don't fall your way. Every choice carries forward—each roll shifts your odds for the next.

The Pocket Push

When you take a risk, roll 2d6 and compare to the **Dice Check (DC)**. At or over the DC is a success. If the result of the roll is unfavorable you can choose to do one or both of the following.

1. **Pocket**: Replace one of the dice with your Pocket
2. **Push**: Mark a pip in a relevant Ability to reroll

Abilities and Pips

The Guide indicates which Abilities to use for a roll.

- **Strength**: fighting and raw power
- **Dexterity**: speed and precision
- **Insight**: depth of knowledge
- **Willpower**: inner drive

An Ability's value is the number of pips you can mark for that Ability.

Advantage and Disadvantage

In Advantage roll an extra die and remove the worst. In Disadvantage roll an extra die and lose the best.

Pocket Rolls

Your Pocket fluctuates with your fate. You can mark Dexterity to reroll any Pocket roll.

- **Pocket:** set your Pocket to d6.
- **Pocket Up:** roll d6 and compare to your Pocket. Take the bigger value.
- **Pocket Down:** roll d6 and compare to your Pocket. Take the smaller value.

Exploding Rolls

Rolls denoted by an asterisk are exploding rolls. Reroll these rolls on 6, adding all the dice rolled this way.

Diminishing Rolls

Each successive die can be at most the one less than the previous die. E.g. rolling 6, 3, 5 results in $6 + 3 + 2$ (diminished).

Items

Exploring the Moonveil means hauling gear — and sometimes hauling friends. Track everything you carry in **Equipment & Backpack**.

- **Slots:** Most items take up 1 slot
 - Larger items take up 2 or more slots
 - Smaller items fit multiple to one slot
- **Extra:** The smallest things like letters, keys, or coins are free to carry

Dungeon Gear

Dungeon Gear is a special item that takes 1 slot. When you need it, it becomes any reasonable adventuring tool like a club or knife, arrows, a tent, rope, torches, rations, etc.

For some kinds of items roll d6 to determine how much is available. For example, if you pull out rope you have d6 x 10 feet of rope; if you pull out rations you have enough food and drink for d6 Seekers.

If you think you might need something in particular, ask the Guide if they would allow it as Dungeon Gear. If they say no, ask if its otherwise available and what it takes to acquire it.

Carrying Your Friends

Carrying a Seeker, without their gear, takes 5 slots. You need to accomodate slots for your own gear and any gear of theirs as well.

Encumbrance

You can carry 6 + Willpower items without penalty. For each item beyond that, you gain **Encumbrance**. Subtract your Encumbrance from every roll before resolving it.

The Armory

Basic Melee	Cost	Description
Club, Knife, or Staff	1	Dungeon Gear can be converted into these
Bomb	2	Range 1. d6 area damage.
Dagger	2	Roll Advantage When Unnoticed
Shortsword	2	Minimum 2
Shortspear	2	Strong +1
Quarterstaff	2	2H Critical +2

Ranged	Cost	Description
Throwing Knife	2	Melee Minimum Damage 2. Range 1. 4:1 Slot
Javelin	2	Melee Strong Damage +1. Range 1. 2:1 Slot
Throwing Axe	3	Melee Critical Damage +d6/2. Range 1.
Bow	2	Range 2.
Longbow	3	Critical Damage +d6*. Range 3 Roll Disadvantage against Near. Spend Action and Move to shoot
Crossbow	6	Strong Damage +2. Range 1. Spend Move to Reload.
Heavy Crossbow	10	Strong Damage +3. Range 2. Action to Reload.
Arrows or Bolts	1	Dungeon Gear can be converted into these

Melee	Cost	Description
Sword	5	Minimum Damage 3
Spear	4	Strong Damage +2
Hammer	4	Critical Damage +d6*
Axe	4	Minimum Damage 2, Critical Damage +2
Whip	3	Target rolls Pocket Down on any hit
Fencing Sword	5	Minimum Damage 2, Dodged? Attacker Loses Move

2H Melee	Cost	Description
Great Club	8	Critical Damage +2d6*
Pike	9	Strong Damage +2, Critical Damage +d6*
Zweihander	10	Minimum Damage 3, Critical Damage +d6*

2H Melee	Cost	Description
Halberd	10	Minimum Damage 2, Strong Damage +1, Critical Damage +d6*

Equipment	Cost	Description
Buckler	4	Pocket is Odd? Evade +1
Tower Shield	6	2 Slots, Evade +1, Cover Allies, Pocket <4? Can't Move
Helmet	2	Limit +1
Cloak	6	Can roll Pocket on Moving
Medium Armor	5	2 Slots, Damage Reduction -1
Heavy Armor	20	3 Slots, Damage Reduction -2
Amulet, Ring	1	Sentimental

Equipment modifiers:

- Evasive X, Evade +X
- Protected X, Limit +X
- Resist, Damage Reduction -X
- Slippery, Can Roll Pocket When Moving
- Edged, Minimum X
- Piercing, Strong +X
- Heavy, Critical +X
- Parrying, when dodging counter attack at disadvantage
- Easy, +1 to Attack Rolls
- Sentimental -> A Skill or Gift
- Cover, Evade +1

Magic

Magic comes in two forms: **Spells** and **Miracles**. Spells are shaped by **Insight** into the unknown. Miracles are drawn forth by sheer **Willpower**.

Casting Magic

When you cast a Spell or Miracle, roll 2d6 against its DC:

- Success: Roll $\geq$ DC – the effect takes place.
- Failure: Roll $<$ DC – the effect fizzles, and you lose it until you Rest.

Spells and Arcane Failure

Each day **The Verge** starts at 5.

If your Spell roll fails at or under The Verge, lose 1 Max HP and increase The Verge +1.

Miracles and Penance

Instead of spending Willpower to reroll a Miracle, you may take on **Guilt**.

- If you have no Guilt, fill 1 Backpack slot with Guilt.
- Otherwise, double the amount you are carrying.

Guilt cannot be discarded. Guilt is removed only by genuine sacrifice, as decided with the Guide.

Insight Spell List

Name	DC	Description
Air Pressure	8	Thick like water
Heavylight	8	Conjure a glowing boulder in your hands.
Eye Spy	8	Conjure a shortlived sprite. See what it sees.
Moonsmell	8	Heightened senses.
Telepathy	8	Extrasensory communication.
Ice Column	8	Conjure a slippery ice structure. Range 1.
Egress	9	You and nearby allies escape to safety.
Fire Blast	9	All near take 2d6 damage.
Invisibility	9	You or something you touch is Invisible.
Magic Orb	10	2d6 area damage.
Hydra	10	Range 1. Summon a flaming serpent. Shoots a nearby enemy for 2 damage. Each round roll d6, it dies on 1.
Sleepsand	12	Sleep

Willpower Miracle List

Name	DC	Description
Shapeshift	8	Into an animal for a short time
Miracle Fist	9	Fist Attack Rolls at Advantage. +1 Damage
Healing Circle	10	Heal +d6 to area
Resurrection	10	Needs relative safety. Must occur shortly after death. 1 HP.
Dawn Arm	11	Touch a Weapon. +d6 damage until a miss

Exploration

Speak with your Guide about your intentions. You can attempt anything, and succeed automatically at anything reasonable. For uncertain or risky actions, make a **Dice Check** or enter an **Encounter**.

Intervals

Each stretch of exploration is one **Interval**.

During an Interval, you may roll Pocket once — a single chance to steady yourself, shift your luck, or find your footing.

When enough risk has been overcome

- Surviving an encounter
- A tense negotiation
- Disarming a trap
- Or something equally dangerous

The Guide begins the next Interval, allowing another chance to reroll Pocket.

Rest, Growth, and Death

Rest

In a safe space, share a meal and spend 8 hours resting to recover.

1. Make a Record

You may choose to **Make a Record** — a note, sketch, meal, or other memento of your experience. **Spend a resource** like Dungeon Gear and

- Describe your creation to the table
- Place it in the **Extra** section of your Backpack
- Roll DC7 Insight to determine if it was successful

2. Level Up

If you reached a milestone

- Increase Level +1
- Gain +1 in an Ability Point

3. Recover

- **Determine HP:** Roll a number of d6 equal to your Level and add ($3 \times \text{Strength}$). You can set your HP to this total.
- Recover Ability Points, Spells, Miracles, and lost HP
- Roll Pocket

Death

At 0 HP you are dying. Only safety and long, sustained care can save you.

If this aid does not come, you are dead. Roll a new Seeker.

Encounters

In a clash of steel or a sprung trap - each moment is a test. You're rolling dice, swapping your Pocket, and spending Ability Points. When you hold the advantage, strike!

Initiative

Encounters are run in rounds. Start each round with a d6 **Initiative** roll to determine when you can act. On a 4–6 you act before the Guide; on a 1–3 you act after the Guide. Reroll by marking Dexterity.

- **Opening Seekers:** if you rolled 4-6 take you can take your turn first
- **Guide:**
 - Take enemy turns
 - Trigger world events
- **Closing Seekers:** if you have yet to take your turn, take it here

On your turn, take a **Move** and an **Action** in any order alongside other Seekers taking their turns.

Movement

Moves change your location, your relative position, or help you regain your footing.

Move Options

When you take a Move, choose from one of the following or anything else you could easily attempt in a moment:

- Spend 1 Move to cross a Distance of 1.
- Spend 1 Move to reposition yourself in melee.
- Spend 1 Move to gain better footing. Roll Pocket.
- Spend an Action to gain an additional Move.

Obstacles

If you need to navigate carefully—such as crawling over allies in a cramped space, avoiding a trap, or crossing a slick surface—roll **Pocket Down**.

If you want to move behind an enemy, **Sneak** with DC10 Dexterity to go unnoticed and move behind an enemy:

- Roll with Advantage if the enemy is engaged with someone or something else.
- Roll with Disadvantage if multiple enemies block the way or the space is narrow.
- On failure the blocking enemy gets a free attack.

Actions

When you take an Action, choose from one of the following or anything else you could reasonably attempt in a moment.

1. Attack

Make an attack to damage an enemy. First confirm the target:

- **Melee:** a nearby enemy, 0 Moves away. The opposing side chooses which enemy
- **Ranged:** an enemy of your choice up to the weapon's Range away.

Then roll 2d6 and compare both dice against the target's **Evade**, **Defense**, and **Limit** to determine if and how hard the attack hits.

Thresholds	Tier	Damage
$\leq$ Evade	Miss	0
$<$ Defense	Weak Hit	1
$\geq$ Defense	Strong Hit	Smaller Die Value
$\geq$ Limit	Critical Hit	Bigger Die Value

2. Deduction

Mark 1 Insight, and work with the Guide to reveal useful information into the challenge at hand.

- Identify an Advantage over a challenge or enemy or remove a Disadvantage affecting the team.
- Reveal a new possibility like an enemy behavior that could be helpful.

Refund if the result is not useful.

3. Rally

Spend an Action and mark 1 Willpower to

- Erase marked pips in Strength, Dexterity, and Insight
- Restore 1d6 Hit Points

Gambits

Wager your Ability Points to perform Gambits.

1. Damage

Before a melee attack if you have at least 1 pip of Strength.

- On a Strong Hit or better, apply
 - d6* bonus damage to the original target or
 - d6 diminishing damage to each nearby enemy
- If your attack roll is less than the target Limit, mark all your Strength.

2. Control

Before a melee attack if you have a Pocket of 4 or more.

- Choose your target among nearby enemies.
- Depending on the Hit
 - Strong Hit, choose one effect
 - Critical Hit, choose two effects
- Effects to choose
 - Force the target to roll Pocket Down
 - Force the target to Move 1
 - Recover your Move
- If your attack roll is less than the target Limit, roll Pocket Down.

3. Precision

Before a ranged attack if you have at least 1 pip of Dexterity.

- Deal double damage or the target rolls Pocket Down
- If your attack roll is less than the target Limit, mark all your Dexterity

4. Full Defend

After being hit if you have at least 1 pip of Dexterity.

- Roll DC10 Dexterity. On success, negate all damage and effects.
- On failure, take full damage, and mark all your Dexterity.